Microsoft Exchange Online

System Administrator's Management Guide

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Exchange Online is Microsoft's cloud-based email service that provides enterprise-grade email, calendaring, and messaging capabilities. As a sysadmin, you manage mailboxes, mail flow, security policies, and compliance across your organization.

What You Manage in Exchange Online

Exchange Online shifts traditional on-premises Exchange administration to the cloud while maintaining familiar management concepts. You control user mailboxes, distribution groups, mail flow rules, and security policies through web-based admin centers and PowerShell.

Core Administrative Tasks

Mailbox Management

- Create and configure user mailboxes
- Set mailbox sizes and quotas
- Manage shared and resource mailboxes
- Configure delegation and permissions
- Handle mailbox moves and migrations

Mail Flow & Transport

- Configure mail flow rules (transport rules)
- Set up connectors for hybrid scenarios
- Manage accepted domains
- Configure email routing and filtering
- Monitor message trace and delivery

Groups & Distribution Lists

- Create and manage distribution groups
- Configure Microsoft 365 Groups
- Set up dynamic distribution groups
- Manage group membership and permissions
- Configure group policies and settings

Security & Compliance

- Configure anti-spam and anti-malware
- Set up data loss prevention (DLP)
- Manage retention policies
- Configure audit logging
- Handle eDiscovery requests

Bottom Line: Exchange Online provides enterprise email capabilities in the cloud with reduced infrastructure overhead. Focus on mail flow configuration, security policies, and compliance requirements while leveraging Microsoft's built-in protection and scaling capabilities.

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